

SANGJUN (SAMUEL) Ko

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Kimberly-Clark — North America Family Care R&D

Neenah, Wisconsin

Statistician (contract assignment through Staffmark Group)

June 2025 – Present

- Serve as statistical lead for 15+ completed and ongoing Test Method Validation and measurement-system studies; develop study designs, sample-size recommendations, randomized and blinded run orders, acceptance criteria, analyses, and qualification recommendations with laboratory, test-method, product, and quality teams.
- Analyze an average of six requested mannequin leakage studies per month across two business units, applying ANOVA, mixed models, least-squares means, multiple comparisons, and sensitivity analyses to interpret product performance and recommend follow-up actions.
- Design and analyze experiments supporting test-method development, equipment qualification, prototype screening, material evaluation, competitive benchmarking, and consumer-study planning.
- Designed and maintain a Python/Flask reporting application that replaced a retiring legacy workflow, allowing 50+ researchers and technicians to generate standardized statistical reports in minutes rather than waiting several days.
- Build, deploy, and maintain six self-service analytics modules and serve as a primary technical contact for the platform, converting manual laboratory and predictive-modeling workflows into accessible tools for R&D users.
- Maintain and further train established product-performance models, coordinate laboratory testing to generate new data, design supporting experiments, analyze results, and deploy user interfaces that improve model visibility and access across R&D.

Applied Technologies for Learning in Arts & Sciences

Champaign, Illinois

AI/ML Intern Team Leader

January 2024 – December 2024

- Led five interns and coordinated priorities and deliverables with three managers while developing and evaluating Python machine-learning models using datasets containing 100,000+ records.
- Applied regression, random forests, XGBoost, neural networks, BERT, and transformer-based methods to predictive-modeling and natural-language-processing projects.

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Champaign, Illinois

Undergraduate Course Assistant — Data Science and Professional Statistics

August 2023 – May 2025

- Mentored 300+ students in data science, statistical analysis, and consulting through interactive laboratories, project feedback, and individualized technical support.
- Managed Git-based updates and edited instructional content for a learning platform serving 1,000+ students.

HappySneeze

Remote

Market Research Intern

August 2024 – September 2024

- Created an interview guide, conducted 10+ consumer interviews on menopause and pelvic-floor health needs, and synthesized findings into product and market recommendations.

SELECTED PROJECTS AND AWARD

Graduation Prediction Model

September 2024 – December 2024

- Increased model AUC from 0.65 to 0.82 through feature engineering and outlier review across 50,000+ student records.
- Built a Streamlit interface using 12 key predictors to provide real-time graduation predictions for university administrators.

3rd Place, 2024 COVID Information Commons Student Paper Challenge

September 2024

- Analyzed socioeconomic and mental-health effects of COVID-19 in Mexico using statistical and geospatial methods and translated findings into intervention recommendations for vulnerable groups.

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Champaign, Illinois

Bachelor of Science in Statistics, Mathematics Minor; GPA: 3.93/4.00

January 2023 – May 2025

University of Michigan–Shanghai Jiao Tong University Joint Institute

Shanghai, China

Coursework toward a B.E. in Mechanical Engineering; transferred to UIUC September 2019 – December 2020

First Class Scholarship

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical methods:	DOE, TMV, Gauge R&R/MSA, mixed models, ANOVA, multiple comparisons, regression, attribute agreement, bias and precision analysis
Programming:	Python, R, SQL, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Excel/VBA
Libraries/frameworks:	Pandas, NumPy, SciPy, statsmodels, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, Flask, Streamlit, Gradio, Matplotlib, Seaborn
Tools:	JMP, Git, Docker, SAS, Tableau, Microsoft Office
Languages:	Korean and Spanish (native); English (fluent)